

H.D. DEVE GOWDA

Janata Dal (Secular) President

B.S. YEDIYURAPPA

BJP leader and former deputy chief minister

H.D. KUMARASWAMY

JD(S) leader and former chief minister

OCTOBER 3-6, 2007: THE WAR OF WORDS

"It is not a dharma yudha but an adharma yudha. The BJP is a vachana brushta (violator of commitments)."

"The JD(S) leadership betrayed the people of this country. Our culture is not one of betrayal."

"The BJP is backed by the Sangh Parivar and the party will disturb communal harmony in the state."

OCTOBER 26-30, 2007: BEATING A RETREAT

"There is no question of talking with the Congress. I will meet Vajpayee, Advani and Rajnath Singh."

"I knew (Kumaraswamy) will abide by the agreement. It is our commitment to the people that drew us together."

"Anything can happen in politics. We are together because the Congress was trying to break us."



JD(S) has also lost the support of a key Lingayat leader M.P. Prakash, who rebelled against party chief Gowda for this sudden turnaround. Prakash was asked to open a channel with the Congress while the father-son duo made peace with BJP.

BJP leaders L.K. Advani and Rajnath Singh met Prime Minister Manmohan Singh in Delhi on Wednesday and cited the Bihar and Bommai judgements to speed up the process of government formation but the stickler in the Manmohan pointed to the Constitution and said the Centre would go strictly by it. But a former state chief minister Veerappa Moily and a Congress heavyweight said the governor is not bound by any such precedents and instead called for an immediate dissolution of the state Assembly. Moily said previous instances only spoke about the stage when the President's Rule had already been imposed and did not discuss anything with regard to Karnataka's

POWER BINDS: (Left) Deve Gowda with Yediyurappa; Kumaraswamy

situation where the same combination was seeking to come together after breaking ties. However, Navkesh Batra, a Bangalore-based lawyer, says, "If the parties have the numbers to form the government, the governor is left with no choice but invite them."

The Constitution has set a two-month deadline for the Parliament to approve or disapprove such proclamation, keeping in mind the time required to convene a session of both the Houses. The Congress-led UPA is likely to use this provision to dissolve the Assembly by passing a resolution in the Parliament or at least delay the government formation process. If the governor does not send the report at all, the matter will be decided by the Parliament, scheduled to meet on November 15. Even if the governor sends a report to the Centre, it has an option to seek the apex court's opinion

and further delay the process of government formation and Yediyurappa's rise to the post of a chief minister.

In such a situation, the parties may not receive an invitation from the governor and there's a strong possibility of an extension of the Central rule. Even Governor Thakur is busy dividing his time between his mansion and the Vidhana Soudha secretariat where three advisers appointed by the Centre—former RAW chief P.K. Hormese Tharakan, former IAS officers P.P. Prabhu and S. Krishnakumar—have started functioning to ensure smooth functioning of the administrative machinery. Another indication of an extended Central rule is the manner in which former advocate-general Uday Holla resigned to pave way for senior counsel B.V. Acharya, the advocate-general in a former Congress regime to assume charge. If all these appointments are meant to signal anything, it is that Karnataka is in for a long period of Central rule. ■